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India - U.S. Relations since the End of Cold War :-

- End of Cold War means New World Order.
It means New Frame of Reference.

Since, Russia was completely weakened, the focus of U.S.A shifted towards China. Hence, the importance of India increased as a Swing State to balance the rise of China.

Since Cold War was over USSR was dis-integrated, India was isolated, even India was looking for New Partnerships.

As India had to open up its Economy, it had to look for markets.

Factors Responsible for Improvement in India - U.S. Relations :-

i) The New World Order.

ii) Opening up of Indian Economy.

iii) The Role of Indian - American Community.

Over a period of time Indian - Americans became one of the most powerful & prosperous community in U.S.A.

The Caucus (Lobby) of Indian - Americans became the most powerful lobby.

There has been a change in leadership in India.

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Rightist came to power in India.

Rightist always favoured closer relation with West.
For Eg.:- At the time of independence, Swatantra Party led by C. Rajagopalachari wanted closer relation with U.S.A.

Why Rightist favour West? - (West = Capitalism)

- Rightist prefer market Economy | Pro-Rich.

* Phases in ^{Post} Cold - War Situation :-

• 1st Phase :- (1991 - 2000)

- India - U.S. Relations were not very close.

Why? -

- India is slow to respond to the changes.

- Indians are traditional peoples. (Tradition of Non-Alignment). After the End of Cold War India became all the more emotional about Non-Alignment.

The signature concept of India's Foreign Policy. It is part of India's identity in World affairs.

The pace of Economic Reforms has been too slow.
Business Environment in India is not Conducive.

What U.S. Wanted? -

- U.S. wanted India to open up its Economy.

- Whether it was in India's Favour? -

Yes, b/c in Global Capitalism competitiveness is needed & not protectionism.

To pressurise India, U.S.A has been pressurising India to sign NPT.

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U.S.A even used Russia to pressurise India to sign NPT.

How?—

- Since Russia was dependent on U.S.A at that time U.S.A wanted to further isolate India to compell India. Hence, U.S.A Pressurized Russia—

i) Not to transfer Cryogenic Engine & technology,

ii) US pressurized Russia to settle the debt not in local currencies but in dollar. India's Financial situation was already bad.

India was supporting the idea of Multi-Polar World and kept on criticising Unipolarity & dangerous on Unilateralism.

Instead of disbanding NAM, India started revitalising NAM.

* 2nd Phase :- (2000 onwards)

— India — U.S. Relations

1998!— Operation Shakti. Means India declared its status as a Nuclear Weapon State.

U.S. imposed Sanctions against India. U.S. accused India of starting New Arms Race.

Why USA opposed India acquiring Nuclear Weapon?—

— B/c it is linked to U.S. Hegemony.

There is a direct connection b/w Nuclear Arms Race in South Asia and in West Asia.

If India will make Nuclear Weapon, Pakistan will also make. Pakistan possessing Nuclear Weapons means Saudi - Arabia possessing Nuclear Weapon. If Saudi - Arabia possess Nuclear Weapon, Iran will go for Nuclear Weapon, it means direct challenge to US Hegemony. Hence, USA imposed sanction.

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* Beginning of Strategic Partnership !—

Role of Jashwant Singh !—

After India acquired Nuclear Weapons, USA continued to pressurise India to sign NPT, CTBT. Hence, USA started dialogue with India. There were 14 Round

of Talk in the span of less than 2 years b/w

Jashwant Singh and U.S. Deputy Secretary of State Strobe Talbott. Talks led the foundation of Strategic Partnership. It played the role in ending the apprehensions against US.

The impact of the talks was that for the first time USA's position on Kashmir in Kargil War was Pro-India.

USA also asked Pakistan —

- a) Respect LOC.
- b) Restrain from use of violence.
- c) Resumption of Talks.

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As a result of the talks, Gradually U.S. started lifting the sanctions.

2000 :- Visit of U.S. President after Long Gap. Last Visit was in 1978.

- This visit led to the beginning of Strategic Partnership. It led to the release of "Vision Document".

2001 :- Vajpayee visited USA called USA as Natural ally.

- Vajpayee's position was subjected to criticism in India.

During the visit, India and USA announced the launch of "Next Steps in Strategic Partnership". (NSSP)

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it will be Civil - Nuclear Agreement Collaboration & also collaboration in Space Technology.

- Collaboration in the field of Science & Technology.
- Collaboration in the field of Energy.

Role of George Bush :-

- Suppose to be the best year of India - U.S. relation.

Why? -

- Finalisation of Civil - Nuclear Agreement.

Since then there has been no such big thing in the relationship.

What was the policy of George Bush towards India? -

- For the first time, USA came up with Independent policy for India. Thus, de-hyphenation started.

The scholar of Indian Origin - Ashley Tellis who was among the advisers played the role in policy shift.

From now onwards, it was declared that engagement with India as well as with Pakistan will develop on independent track.

Why USA removed Sanctions against Indian entities (like- DRDO, ISRO)? -

- B/c the importance of India had increased in context of rising China.

- A/c to C. Rajamohan, → his book "Crossing the Rubicom".

What was the Rubicom / Puzzle? -

The Puzzle for India was whether to maintain the threshold status or to declare the Nuclear Weapon Status.

Views of C. Rajamohan :-

- Indian elites took the calculated risk. They realised that either they have to declare their Nuclear weapon status now or never.

Why? -

- B/c USA was pro-actively supporting CTBT. If Treaty have come into existence, India would not have been in a position to test Nuclear Weapon capabilities.

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Indian Strategic Community could calculate that even when there will be sanctions against India, sanctions will not continue for long.

Why ?-

- If USA is looking towards India as a balancer to China, Nuclear India is a better balancer than Non-Nuclear.

Things fallen in place with God's grace. & events moved as per Indian script.

* Civil - Nuclear Agreement :- (1,2,3 Agreement)

- It came into force in 2005 during Manmohan Singh's visit.

Q) Critically examine the role of Civil-Nuclear Deal in the transformation of India - U.S. Relations.

- Indo-US Civil-Nuclear Agreement has been a great game changer. The importance of the deal goes beyond the scope of the agreement.

"Deal" is the best example of India's diplomacy so far.

• Game Changer :-

USA has been pushing India to sign NPT. Still USA continue with Civil-Nuclear Cooperation.

However, in 1974, after Pokharan-I, USA imposed sanctions and used its political might to create Nuclear Apartheid against India.

↳ Means no Nuclear Commerce with India against Indian Experiment USA launched NSG in 1978 and MTCR in 1987.

This had impacted India's three stage Nuclear Programme, India could not have success in developing the Indigenous technology for the Commercial exploitation of Thorium Reserves.

① Salient Features of the Deal :-

⇒ Indian Promises :-

- i) India will go for the separation of its civilian and Military Programme / Facilities.
- ii) India will put its civilian facilities under the watch of IAEA.
For this, India will sign special safeguard agreement with IAEA.
- iii) India will bring the liability loss in accordance to International Standards, so that Nuclear Commerce can be started.

⇒ American Promises / Obligations :-

- i) U.S. will bring change in domestic laws.
- ii) U.S. will get India specific waiver from NSG guidelines w/c will allow to start Nuclear Commerce with India.
- iii) U.S. will work to get India's entry in NSG, MTCR, Australia Group & Wassenaar Group.
- iv) U.S.A's promise full Civil - Nuclear Co-operation.
Even transfer of technology including Re-processing technology.

★ The deal restrict India from further testing. In case, India go for further testing U.S. has Right to suspend the agreement. Thus, the agreement brings India under CTBT w/o signing CTBT.

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At the same time, NPT- the key pillar of the Global Nuclear Order changed for India. India got exceptional treatment.

What is the exceptional treatment? -

NPT member can't go for Nuclear Commerce or exchange with Non- NPT states. Thus, India gets the benefits of Civil- Nuclear exchange even w/o signing NPT.

India got the treatment at par with Nuclear Weapon State.

Under NPT there are two categories of state:-

- i) Nuclear Weapon State.
- ii) Non- Nuclear Weapon State.

↳ these state are under obligation to put all of their facilities under IAEA safeguards.

India is not obliged to put all the facilities.

The deal had so far benefited only India i.e. why there has been a dissatisfaction that USA didn't get benefit. B/c Nuclear Commerce with USA could not get materialise b/c of disagreement over India's liabilities law.

a) The benefit of the agreement has gone to Russia.

b) However, India's importance for USA goes beyond their commercial calculus.